

ANALYZING GENDER BIAS IN PUBLIC DISCOURSE AROUND 'FEMMINICIDIO' AND 'VIOLENZA DI GENERE':

A MIXED-METHODS APPROACH USING YOUTUBE COMMENTS AND OFFICIAL STATISTICS

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INTRODUCTION

- GBV = persistent and urgent societal issue.
- “Femminicidio” reflects structural violence against women.
- YouTube = key platform for public sentiment and emotional expression.
- Explore how digital discourse mirrors/supports/resists gender norms.



NEVER
“IT'S JUST
A JOKE”

Sexual harassment, bullying and discrimination
are never fun. *It's time for a better world.*



RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1 HOW IS GENDER BIAS EXPRESSED ON YOUTUBE?

2 HOW DOES SENTIMENT RELATE TO GENDERED LANGUAGE?

3 DO ONLINE NARRATIVES ALIGN WITH REAL-WORLD EVENTS?

4 WHAT DISCURSIVE PATTERNS EMERGE—AND HOW MIGHT THEY AFFECT PUBLIC UNDERSTANDING?

METHODOLOGY

DATA COLLECTION + NUDM

25.000 + Italian YouTube comments + Non Una Di Meno dataset

SENTIMENT ANALYSIS

FEEL-IT transformer model → classification +/- comments

TOPIC MODELLING

LDA (k=4 for thematic richness) → identification of latent topics

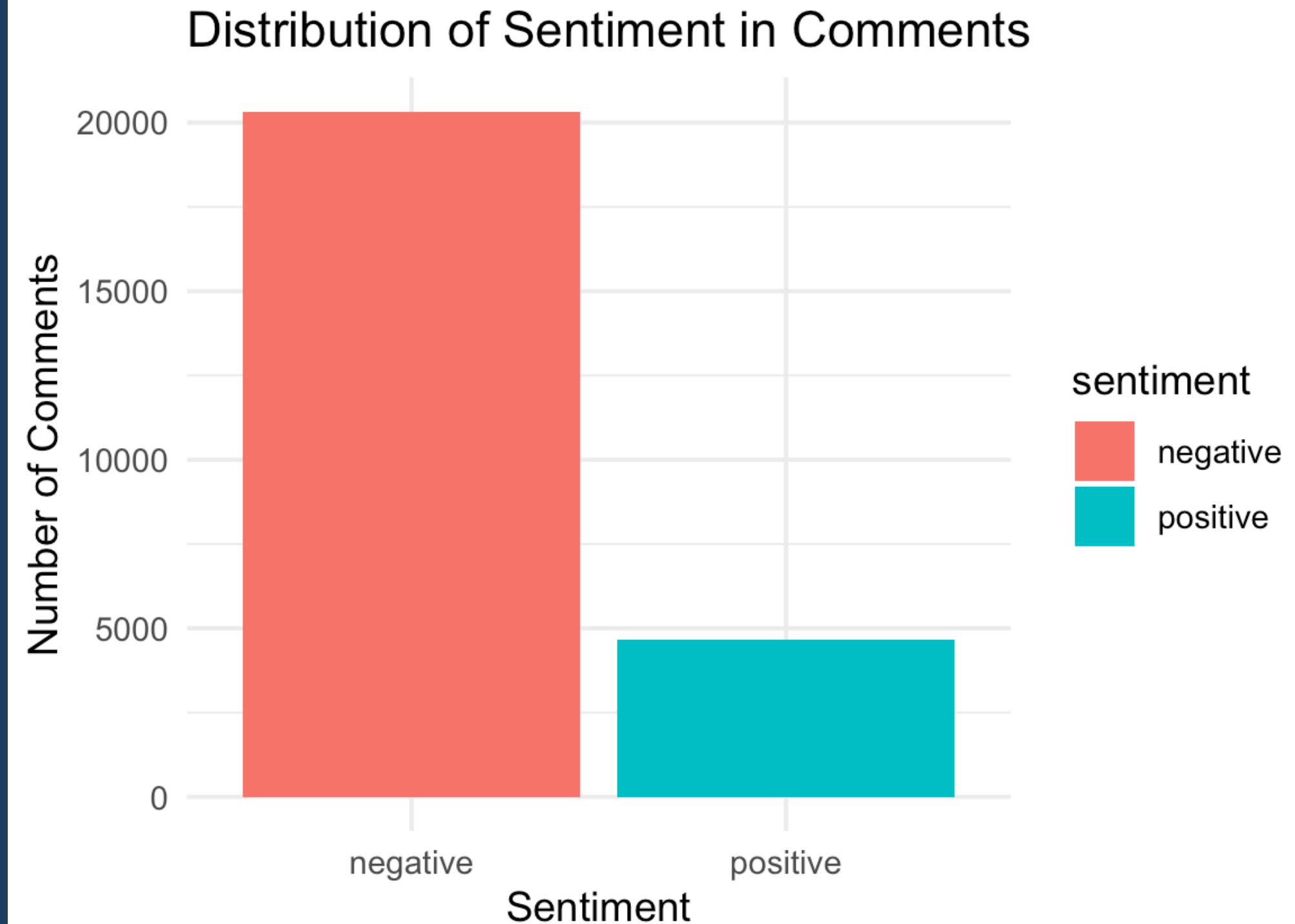
AWARENESS DETECTION

Rule-based keyword analysis → identification of conscious engagement with GBV

SENTIMENT ANALYSIS

75% of comments = negative sentiment

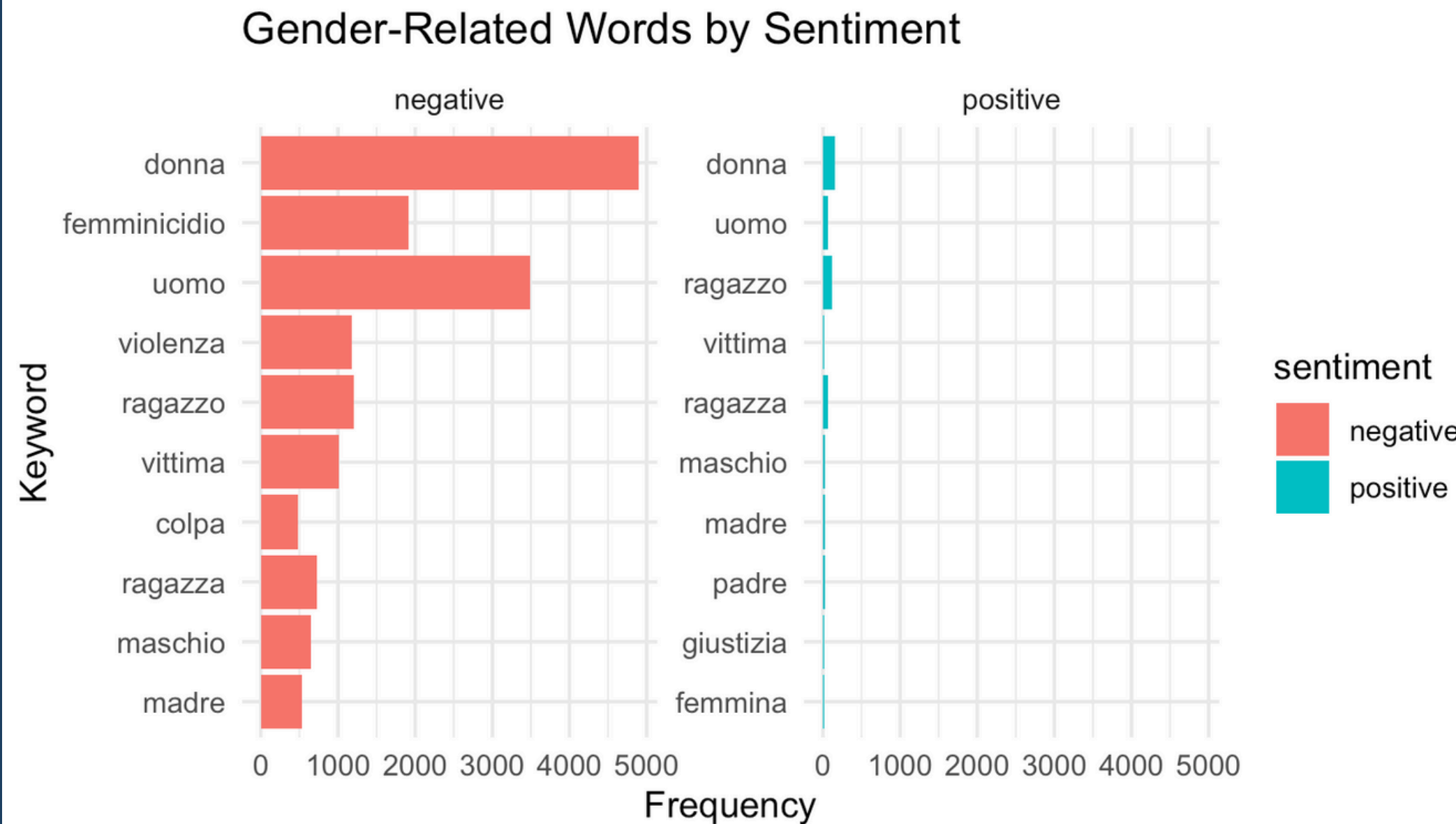
Includes outrage, grief, institutional critique, victim-blaming, and calls for justice.



SENTIMENT ANALYSIS

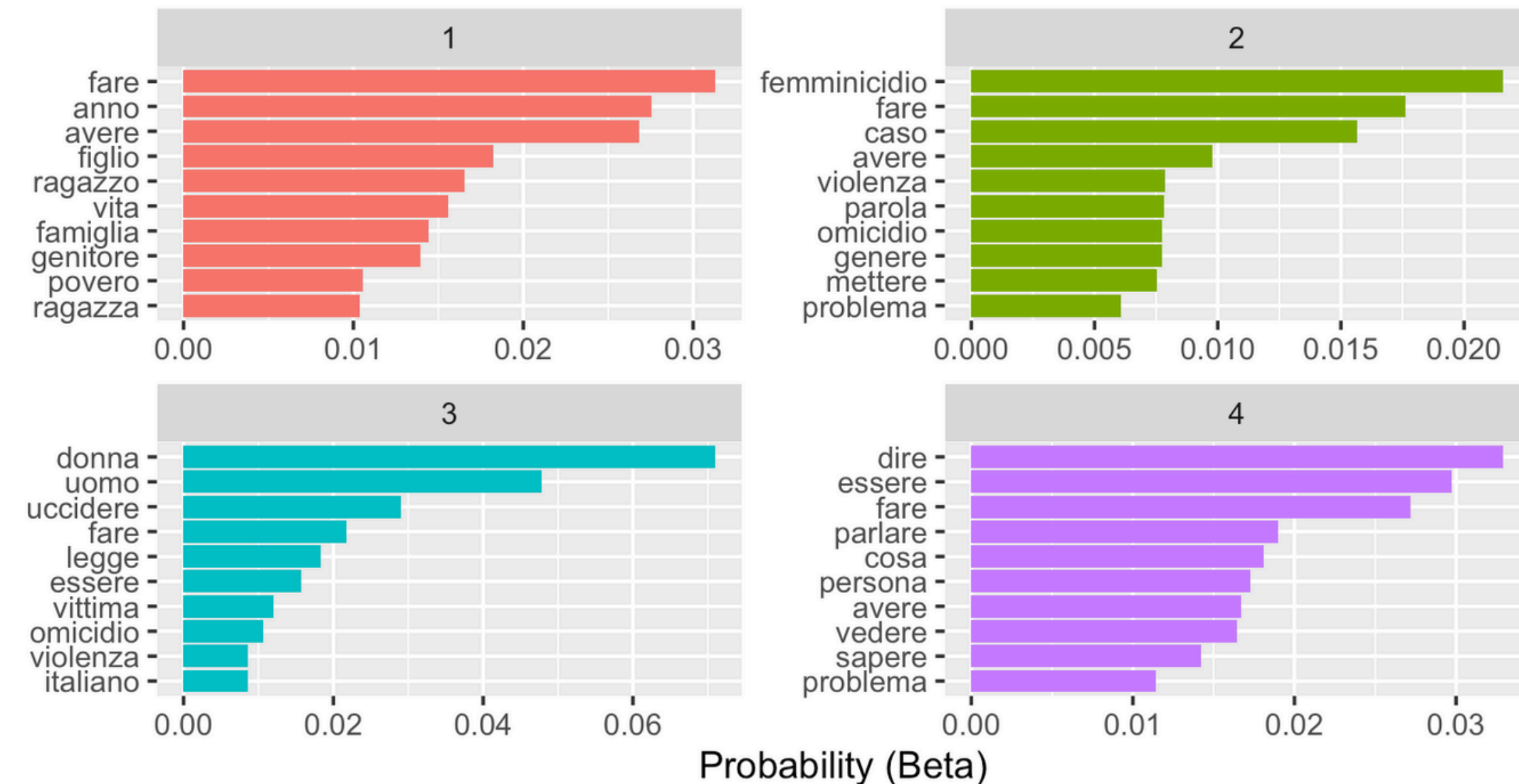
75% of comments = negative sentiment

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TOPIC MODELLING

Top Terms per Topic (Negative Sentiment)



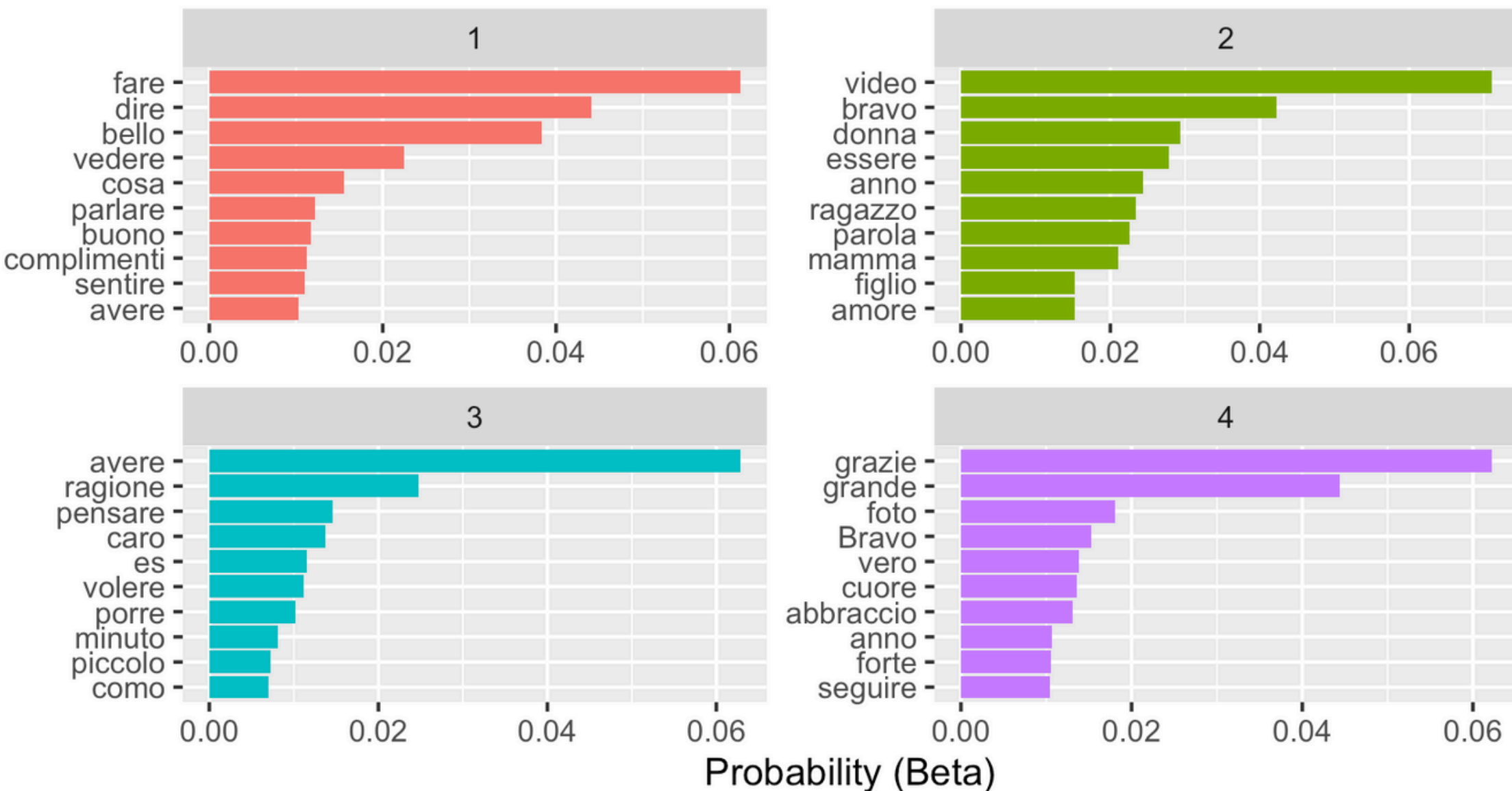
Key topics:

- Institutional failure & justice gaps
- Gendered violence & victim narratives
- Emotional reactions (support vs blame)
- Ideological debate around feminism

Shared vocabulary → thematic consistency across sentiments.

TOPIC MODELLING

Top Terms per Topic (Positive Sentiment)



Key topics:

- Institutional failure & justice gaps
- Gendered violence & victim narratives
- Emotional reactions (support vs blame)
- Ideological debate around feminism

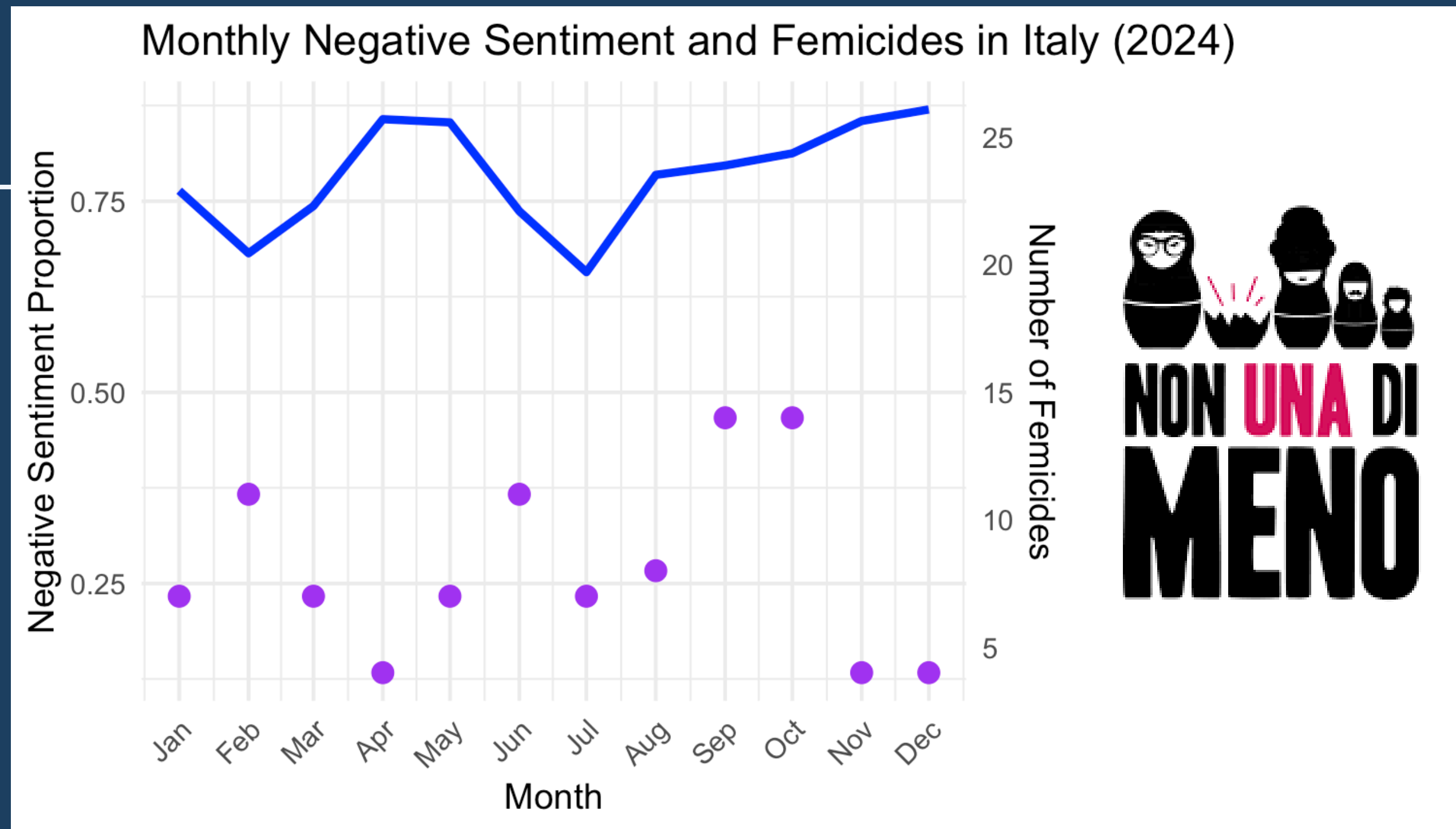
Shared vocabulary → thematic consistency across sentiments.

TEMPORAL TRENDS

YOUTUBE COMMENTS

NON UNA DI MENO DATASET

Discourse spikes
follow real-world
events

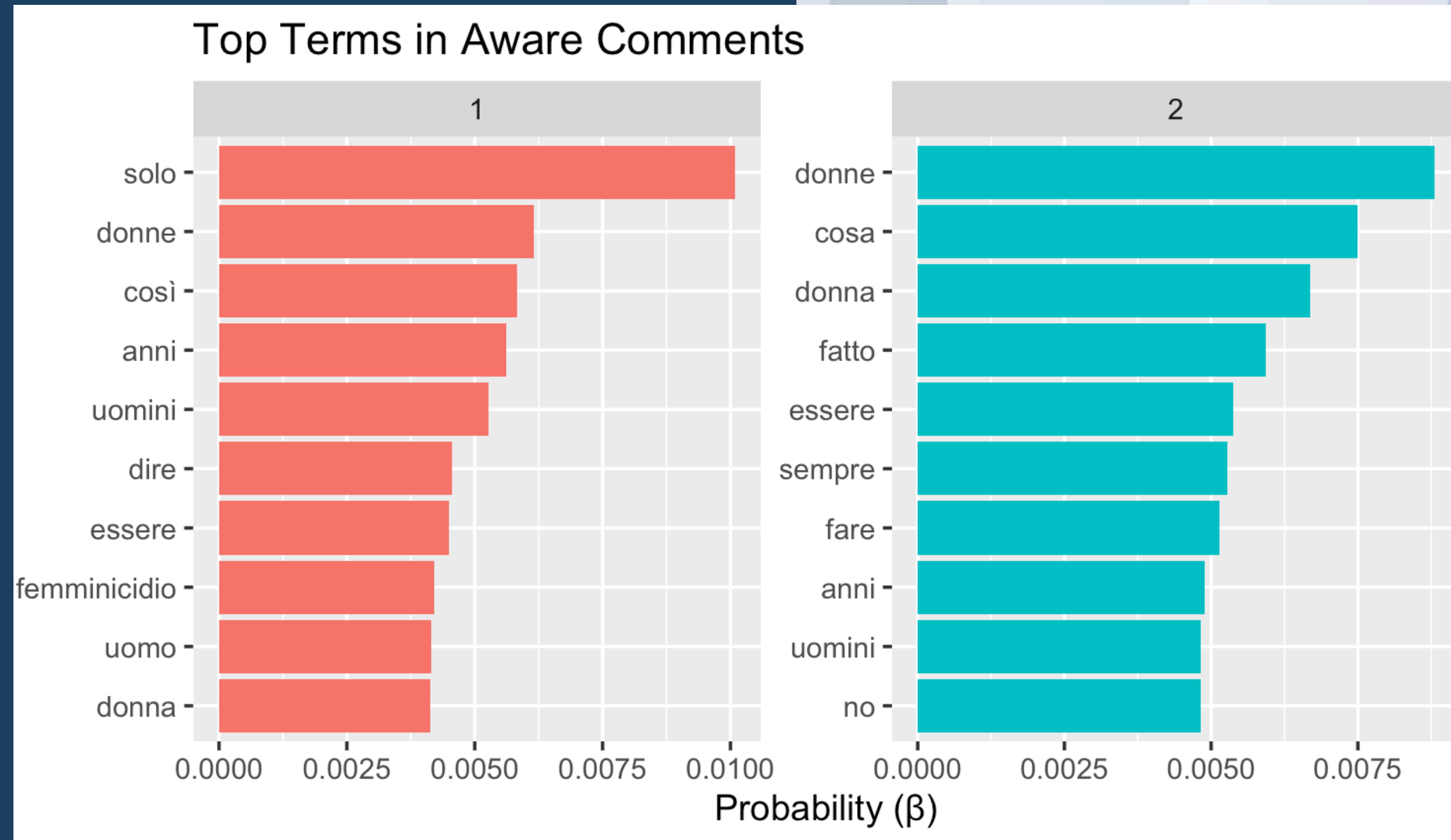


AWARENESS DETECTION

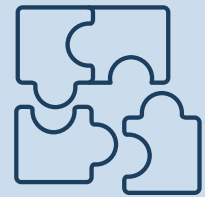
Keyword matches (e.g.,
patriarcato, cultura dello stupro)

awareness comments =
supportive but also sarcastic,
resistant, hostile

Keyword presence $\neq$ alignment
with feminist views



LIMITATIONS



Sarcasm & irony
miscalassified by
sentiment model

Awareness detection
doesn't capture
stance



YouTube user
bias: younger,
male-skewed

Lack of demographic
metadata from API



CONCLUSION

YOUTUBE REFLECTS AND AMPLIFIES SOCIETAL ATTITUDES ON GBV

DIGITAL DISCOURSE IS EMOTIONAL, REACTIVE, AND POLARISED

MIXED METHODS + CRITICAL INTERPRETATION = ESSENTIAL

FINDINGS USEFUL FOR: POLICY DESIGN, ACTIVISM STRATEGY, MEDIA
INTERVENTIONS

THANK
YOU

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